derived from the verbal root **dhr* which has the general meaning 'continuing in existence' and 'support'.

Dravya means substance or a stable entity that continues more or less the same through time. This meaning derives from the verbal form *dravati* ('it runs') since a substance is a constant factor running through time.

Diksha means the initiation ritual into a cult. It is explained as that through which knowledge is provided (*di-yate*), and by which whatever contracts the soul's self-understanding is destroyed (*kshiyate*).

Atman (soul) is explained by the verb *apnoti*, meaning 'it pervades' and 'it obtains' since the soul pervades, controls and supports the body and cognitively grasps objects.

Further reading: Kahrs 1998

Nirvana: a basic Buddhist belief is that there is no substantial enduring Self or Soul (***atman***). *Nirvana* is liberation from the ultimately meaningless and unsatisfactory series of births after the extinction of the fires of craving, hatred and delusion. It is the end of individual personality and its selfish obsessions. The early traditions refer to the 'blowing out' of the fires of clinging, hostility and delusion, which means the end of suffering (***duhkha***). (The fires metaphor is deliberate. It refers to the three fires which the Hindu Brahminical householder was obliged to keep burning and which symbolised his life, responsibilities and attachments as a man in the world.) *Nirvana* is beyond being and becoming. It is unthinkable and indescribable. It is neither a heavenly state nor an oceanic consciousness into which individuals are absorbed. From our point of view, it is sheer nothingness.

According to the early Buddhist ***Abhidharma*** traditions *nirvana* may be attained while one is still alive through insight into the ***Four Noble Truths*** and by the